PassFrame
TUITION

The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter

Year 4 — 11+ Homework Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Clara had grown up with the sea as her nearest neighbour. Her father kept the lighthouse on Raven's Point, and every evening she watched him climb the spiral stairs to light the great lamp before darkness swallowed the water whole.

That night, the storm arrived early. Rain hammered the windows like a thousand tiny fists, and the wind howled around the tower so fiercely that the whole building seemed to shiver. Clara's father had gone down to check the boat, leaving her alone at the top of the stairs.

Then, through the streaming glass, she saw it: a small light out on the black water, flashing weakly, then vanishing, then flashing again. A ship in trouble, with no one to guide it home.

Clara knew the rules — only the keeper was allowed to touch the lamp. But she also knew that by the time her father climbed back up, the ship might already be lost on the rocks. Her hands trembling, she turned the great wheel herself, and the beam swung out across the water like a long golden arm, pointing the ship safely away from the reef.

When her father finally returned, soaked through and breathless, he found Clara still at the wheel, her jaw set with determination. He said nothing about the rules that night — only wrapped her in a blanket and told her, quietly, that she had the makings of a fine lighthouse keeper.

Questions

25 min · 12 questions

1. What was the name of the headland where the lighthouse stood?

2. What had Clara watched her father do every evening?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you Clara was alone when she spotted the light.

4. Underline the simile that describes the beam of the lighthouse.

5. What does “vanishing” mean as it is used to describe the distant light?

6. Put these events in order: Clara turns the wheel / the storm arrives early / Clara's father checks the boat / Clara's father returns soaked through.

7. Why might the author have chosen a storm as the setting for this story?

8. What physical clue shows that Clara's father had been out in the storm himself?

9. Why do you think Clara's jaw was “set with determination” when her father found her?

10. What does her father's final comment suggest about how he felt about what Clara had done?

11. Find and copy a word that means “shaking slightly”.

12. Write one or two sentences predicting what Clara might do when she is older, using evidence from the text.